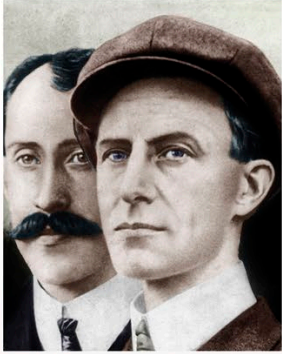
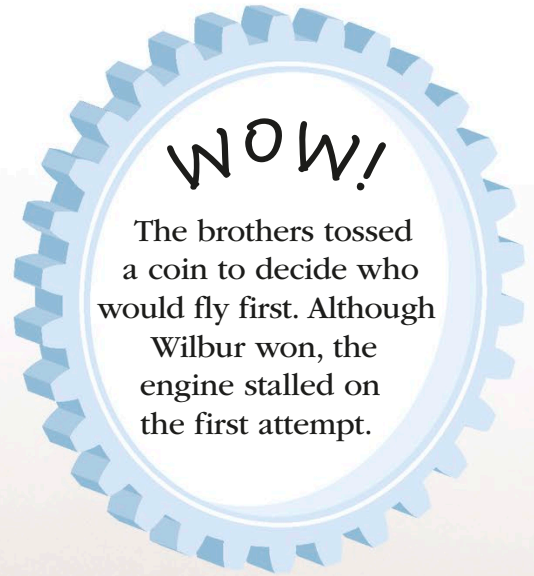


The Wright brothers



The age of aviation began when the American brothers Wilbur and Orville Wright made the first successful powered airplane flight. This was accomplished in their *Flyer* at Kitty Hawk in North Carolina on December 17, 1903. Many pioneers had tried to fly planes with engines before, but they always crashed. The Wright brothers' breakthrough was controlling the flight—the *Flyer* traveled just 120ft (37m), but it took off and landed in full control.



LIFE STORY

1867

Wilbur Wright is born on a farm near Newcastle, Indiana. His brother Orville is born four years later in Dayton, Ohio.

1896

The brothers begin as bicycle makers, but turn to flying after hearing of the German aviator Otto Lilienthal's pioneering hang-glider flights.

1899

The brothers move to Kitty Hawk in North Carolina and they begin building trial planes to improve their flying skills.

1903

Orville makes the first powered, controlled flight in the *Flyer*. This kick-starts a new age in aviation.